

Rebellion + Desertion = Curses

Deuteronomy 28:15–68 — Disease and affliction terms (Hebrew → English)

Source: Westminster Leningrad Codex (Hebrew). English glosses follow standard literal translations (KJV, JPS, NASB, ESV). The Living Bible (TLB) is not used.

Scope: Every verse from 15 through 68. Where a verse names a disease or bodily/mental affliction, it is listed with Hebrew, Strong's number, and English. Verses with no disease term are marked —.

Egypt: Only where this chapter names Egypt (vv. 27, 60). No Exodus plague inventory is imported unless stated here.

Diseases and afflictions by verse

Verse	Hebrew	Strong's	English (literal)	Notes
15	— (intro: curses shall overtake you; no disease named)			
16	— (cursed in city and field)			
17	— (cursed basket and kneading-trough)			
18	— (cursed fruit of body, land, cattle)			
19	— (cursed coming in and going out)			
20	— (curse, confusion, rebuke — not disease terms)			
21	דָּבָר	H1698	pestilence / plague (epidemic disease)	Shall cleave to you until consumed from the land
22	שִׁחָתָה	H7829	consumption / wasting disease	Four bodily afflictions. Same verse also lists <i>cherev</i> (sword), <i>shiddaphon</i> (crop blasting), <i>yeraqon</i> (mildew) — not human diseases.
	קִדְמָת	H6920	fever	
	דִּלְקָה	H1816	inflammation / inflammatory disease	
	מִרְחָר	H2746	extreme burning / fiery heat	
23	— (bronze heavens, iron earth)			
24	— (dust for rain)			

Verse	Hebrew	Strong's	English (literal)	Notes
25	— (defeat before enemies)			
26	— (corpses food for birds and beasts)			
27	שָׁחִין מִצְרַיִם	H7822	boil(s) of Egypt	All incurable. Egypt named in this verse. Ketiv/Qere: written <i>ophalim</i> , read <i>techorim</i> .
	עֲפָלִים	H6076	tumors / swellings / emerods	
	טָחָרִים	H2914	hemorrhoids / tumors	
	גָּרַב	H1618	scab / skin eruption	
	חֶרֶס	H2775	itch / dry eruption	
28	שִׁגְעוֹן	H7697	madness	Mental and sensory afflictions
	עִוְרוֹן	H5788	blindness	
	תַּמְהוֹן לֵב	H8541	confusion / bewilderment of heart	
29	— (groping like the blind — repeats blindness metaphor; no new disease term)			
30	— (wife, house, vineyard taken)			
31	— (ox, donkey, sheep lost)			
32	— (children taken captive)			
33	— (oppression; crops eaten by foreigners)			
34	מִשְׁגָּע	H7696	driven mad / maddened	From <i>shaga</i> (Pu'al); grief at what the eyes see. Same concept as v. 28 <i>shigaon</i> .
35	שָׁחִין רַע	H7822	severe boil(s)	From sole of foot to crown of head; incurable. Same root as v. 27.
36	— (exile; serve other gods)			
37	— (horror, proverb, byword)			
38	— (locusts consume crops)			
39	— (worm eats vines)			
40	— (olives drop off)			
41	— (children go into captivity)			
42	— (locust possesses trees and fruit)			

Verse	Hebrew	Strong's	English (literal)	Notes
43	— (foreigner rises; you sink)			
44	— (lending reversed; head and tail)			
45	— (curses pursue until destroyed)			
46	— (sign and wonder on you and seed)			
47	— (did not serve with joy)			
48	— (hunger, thirst, nakedness, want — deprivation, not disease)			
49	— (nation from afar)			
50	— (fierce nation, no mercy)			
51	— (enemy eats livestock and produce)			
52	— (siege of cities)			
53	— (eat flesh of children in siege)			
54	— (tender man withholds food from family)			
55	— (will not share child's flesh)			
56	— (delicate woman's eye evil toward family)			
57	— (secretly eats afterbirth and children)			
58	— (failure to keep the law)			
59	מִכּוֹת ... חֲלָיִים רָעִים	H4347, H2483	great plagues / strokes; sore sicknesses	Summary categories (on you and your seed), not new named diseases
	(plural forms)	—	of long continuance	
60	כָּל־מִדְּוָה מִצְרַיִם	H4064	all the diseases of Egypt	Egypt named in this verse. Collective curse; shall cleave to you.
61	כָּל־חֲלָי	H2483	every sickness	Catch-all: every sickness and plague <i>not written in this book</i>
	כָּל־מַכָּה	H4347	every plague / stroke	
62	— (few left; disobedience)			
63	— (LORD rejoices to destroy)			
64	— (scattered among nations)			
65	לֵב רָגַז	H7264	trembling heart	Exile afflictions: body and soul wasting

Verse	Hebrew	Strong's	English (literal)	Notes
	כְּלִיֹּן עֵינַיִם	H3631	failing / wasting of the eyes	
	דָּאָבוֹן נֶפֶשׁ	H1671	despair / languishing of soul	
66	— (life hangs in doubt; fear night and day)			
67	— (dread of heart and sight of eyes)			
68	— (return to Egypt in ships; slavery)			

Summary

Named disease/affliction terms (distinct Hebrew roots)

- **17 distinct terms** if *ophalim* (H6076) and *techorim* (H2914) are counted separately.
- **16 distinct terms** if those two are treated as one hemorrhoid/tumor complex (as many English Bibles render them).
- **Physical/bodily:** pestilence, consumption, fever, inflammation, burning heat, boils (Egypt), tumors, hemorrhoids, scab, itch, severe boils (full body), failing eyes.
- **Mental/sensory:** madness, blindness, confusion of heart, maddened (v. 34), trembling heart, despair of soul.
- **Collective formulas:** great plagues and sicknesses (v. 59); all diseases of Egypt (v. 60); every sickness and plague not in this book (v. 61).

Verses that name diseases or afflictions

21, 22, 27, 28, 34, 35, 59, 60, 61, 65

Egypt (this chapter only)

- **28:27** — שֶׁחִין מִצְרַיִם (boil of Egypt)
- **28:60** — כָּל־מְדוּנָה מִצְרַיִם (all the diseases of Egypt)

Rebellion + Desertion = Curses — Deuteronomy 28 opens the curse section (v. 15) with disobedience to the LORD's voice and commandments. The diseases listed above are covenant sanctions for that rebellion and forsaking of God (cf. v. 20).

